Survey About PrivacyAssist

On May 25, 2018, the European Union (EU) adopted the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), a comprehensive laws that governs, among other things, how apps and websites must handle the collection, processing, sharing, and storage of users personal data. The GDPR is based on two main principles: (1) lawfulness: personal data can only be collected with the user's explicit permission, and (2) transparency: users must be clearly informed why their data is being collected and how it will be used and shared.

Android OS uses a permission mechanism to comply with the lawfulness criteria of GDPR. However, permissions in Android have levels of "normal" or "dangerous". While dangerous-level permissions require explicit user consent, normal-level permissions can be automatically approved when users install the application. Additionally, dangerous level permissions are also complex, with multiple meanings, despite affecting the same type of sensitive data. For example, ACCESS_COARSE_LOCATION and ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION are both permissions to request access to location data; however, the first one has a lower accuracy, with an error of 700-1000m, while the second one has an error of only 1-3m. Furthermore, Android apps only ask users to confirm permission (i.e., agree or disagree) without providing a mechanism to explain the meaning of the permission, thereby supporting users in making informed decisions.

To comply with GDPR transparency criteria, Google requires app developers to list all sensitive data that the app will collect and share in the Data Safety section of the Google Play console. However, users must proactively check this information since Android does not provide any warnings to users about how the app uses their sensitive data when they install it.

Despite implementing the permission mechanism and Data Safety, numerous studies have demonstrated that the inconsistency of app permissions and data safety lists can lead to significant security and privacy violations.

Therefore, in our research, we propose a tool to support users and warning them about inconsistencies between permissions and data safety, called **PrivacyAssist**. This tool aims to support users in making decisions when installing and uninstalling apps.

The survey is structured into 2 parts with the following goals:

(1) surveying users' awareness of Android permissions and data safety, as well as users' actual practices when they install apps.

(2) surveying users' experiences after being provided with and using **PrivacyAssist**

Note:

This survey is solely for research purpose. We do not collect any personal data from participants. Survey results can be deleted at any time upon request. Survey results are only stored for 30 days.

You are not required to provide an email address when conducting the survey; this is optional. The purpose of collecting emails is to provide survey results while promoting transparency and engagement among participants with the research you contribute. Additionally, emails allow us to easily invite you to participate in future rounds of data collection. Furthermore, email addresses help verify the authenticity of responses, reduce the likelihood of duplicate or fraudulent submissions, and enhance data reliability.

* Indica una domanda obbligatoria

1. Email address

_____

Demographics

2. Age group *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- <18
- 18-24
- 25-34
- 35-44
- 45-54
- ≥55

3. How would you describe your **tech-savviness**? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Basic
- Intermediate
- Advanced

4. How would you describe your privacy-**savviness?** *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Basic
- Intermediate
- Advanced

5. Frequency of Android app installs *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Daily
- Weekly
- Less than monthly
- Monthly

Awareness & Practice

6. Do you care about app permissions and Data Safety when installing an app *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Yes, definitely
- Probably
- Maybe
- Unlikely
- No, not interested

7. How would you rate your understanding of Android permissions and Data Safety? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- No understanding
- Basic
- Moderate
- Good
- Excellent

8. When installing an app, do you usally check the "App permission"? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Always
- Often
- Sometimes
- Rarely
- Never

9. When installing an app do you usually check the "Data Safety" section on Google Play? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Always
- Often
- Sometimes
- Rarely
- Never

10. Do you feel concerned if an app's permissions and Data Safety are inconsistent? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Not concerned
- Slightly concerned
- Neutral
- Concerned
- Highly Concerned

11. Do you know how to find out which sensitive data (e.g., location, contacts, online activity) an app collects or shares? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

12. What is the main reason you don’t check Permissions/Data Safety? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Didn't know it exists
- Too complicated
- Trust the developer
- No time
- Other

13. Have you ever refused to install or uninstalled an app due to excessive permissions or unclear Data Safety info? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Yes
- No

14. In your opinion, is the current Data Safety disclosure on Google Play transparent and easy to understand? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Very unclear
- Unclear
- Neutral
- Clear
- Very clear

User Support Preferences

This section explores your need for privacy support tools and your preferred format for receiving warnings about inconsistencies between app permissions and Data Safety information.

15. Would you find it helpful to have a tool that warns you when an app's Permissions and Data Safety information is inconsistent or risky? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Very helpful
- Helpful
- Not sure
- Not helpful

16. Which type of support tool would you prefer? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Add-on in Google Play
- Stand-alone app
- Android notifications
- Step-by-step guide
- Other

User Evaluation of PrivacyAssist

This section evaluates your experience with PrivacyAssist, including its usefulness, clarity of warnings, and impact on your installation decisions.

17. I am satisfied with this tool. *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

18. The notifications are clear and intuitive *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

19. The notifications accurately identify inconsistencies between Permissions and DataSafety (after you manually check) *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

20. The tool has improved your understanding of Android permissions and Data Safety *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

21. The tool influences my decision to install or unistall apps. *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

22. Have you ever canceled an installation after the tool's warning? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Yes
- No

23. Would you recommend this tool to others? *

Contrassegna solo un ovale.

- Definitely yes
- Probably
- Not sure
- No

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Google Moduli